

Absolutely — **paint** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it indirectly through **painting**, but the family covers **the coloured substance, the act of applying it, creating a picture, digitally drawing/markings, and figurative description**.

Word family: **paint / painted / painting / painter**

Base word: paint

Verb forms: paint, paints, painted, painting

Related forms: painter, painting

Useful compounds / extensions: paintbrush, paintwork, oil paint, wall paint, spray paint

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your passage contains:

> “A **painting** I would really love to have in my home...”

and later:

> “At that age, I did not know much about **painting**...”

These are related but not identical uses.

Meaning 1 in your passage: **painting = a picture made with paint — 畫作 ; 繪畫作品**

In:

> “A painting I would really love to have in my home...”

painting means:

> **a picture or artwork created by applying paint to a surface such as canvas, wood, or paper.**

繁體中文 :

用顏料在畫布、木板、紙張等表面創作出來的圖畫 / 藝術作品

Natural translation:

> “A painting I would really love to have in my home...”

「我很想放在家中的一幅**畫作**.....」

So here:

> **painting = 畫作 / 繪畫作品**

Meaning 2 in your passage: **painting = the art/activity of making pictures with paint — 繪畫；畫畫**

In:

> “I did not know much about painting...”

painting means:

> **the art, skill, or activity of creating pictures using paint.**

繁體中文：

使用顏料創作圖畫的藝術、技巧或活動；繪畫

Natural translation:

> “At that age, I did not know much about painting.”

「那個年紀的我其實不太懂**繪畫 / 繪畫藝術**。」

So:

> **painting = 畫作**

> or

> **painting = 繪畫這門藝術 / 活動**

Context decides.

1. **paint = coloured liquid/substance used to cover surfaces — 油漆；塗料；顏料**

The core noun meaning.

Practice 1

> “The wall needs another coat of **paint**.”

「這面牆需要再上一層**油漆**。」

Practice 2

> “The artist mixed blue and green paint.”

「畫家混合了藍色和綠色**顏料**。」

****paint = 塗在表面上形成顏色或保護層的有色液體 / 物質****

Natural Chinese depends on context:

* wall paint = 油漆 / 塗料

* artist's paint = 顏料

2. ****paint = verb, apply paint to a surface — 油漆；塗上顏色****

Practice 3

> “They ****painted**** the room white.”

「他們把房間****漆成白色****。」

Practice 4

> “She painted the door last weekend.”

「她上週末替門****上了油漆****。」

****paint = 把油漆 / 顏料塗在物件表面，使其變色或受保護****

3. ****paint = create a picture using paint — 繪畫；畫****

A major verb sense.

Practice 5

> “Monet often ****painted**** water and gardens.”

「Monet 經常****畫****水景和花園。」

Practice 6

> “She likes to paint landscapes.”

「她喜歡****畫風景畫****。」

****paint = 使用顏料創作圖畫****

This differs from:

> paint a wall

> = 油漆牆壁

vs

> paint a landscape

> = 畫風景畫

4. ****paint = depict/represent something in a picture — 描繪；畫出****

A more representational verb sense.

Practice 7

> “The artist ****painted**** the garden at sunset.”

「畫家****描繪 / 畫下****日落時的花園。」

Practice 8

> “She painted the flowers in soft colours.”

「她用柔和色調****畫出 / 描繪****那些花。」

****paint = 把某人、某物或場景透過繪畫呈現出來****

This is closely related to artistic creation, so I would merge it conceptually rather than split it too aggressively.

5. ****paint = describe vividly in words — 生動描繪；刻畫****

A major figurative meaning.

Practice 9

> “The writer ****paints**** a vivid picture of city life.”

「作者****生動描繪****城市生活。」

Practice 10

> “The article paints him as a careful leader.”

「這篇文章把他**描繪成**一位謹慎的領導者。」

****paint — figurative = 用文字、言語或敘述把某人 / 某事呈現成某種形象****

Common patterns:

* paint a picture of...

* paint someone as...

This is excellent MCQ material because no literal paint is involved.

6. ****paint = mark/colour digitally or graphically — 在畫面上繪製；著色****

A modern technology/design extension.

Practice 11

> “Use the brush tool to ****paint**** over the area.”

「用筆刷工具在該區域上****塗畫 / 著色****。」

Practice 12

> “The software lets users paint directly on the image.”

「這套軟件讓使用者直接在圖片上****繪畫 / 上色****。」

****paint — digital = 使用繪圖工具在數碼圖像上加上顏色或筆觸****

7. ****paint = cover/mark something broadly with colour — 塗滿；染上****

A broader extension.

Practice 13

> “The sunset ****painted**** the clouds orange.”

「夕陽把雲朵**染成橙色**。」

Practice 14

> “Autumn painted the hills red and gold.”

「秋天把山坡**染成紅金色**。」

paint — figurative/literary = 使某物呈現某種鮮明色彩，彷彿被顏料塗上

This is figurative/literary.

8. **painting = artwork — 畫作**

This is your first source use.

Practice 15 — Source

> “A **painting** I would really love to have in my home...”

「我很想放在家中的一幅**畫作**.....」

Practice 16

> “The museum owns several famous paintings.”

「博物館收藏了幾幅著名**畫作**。」

painting — countable noun = 一幅以顏料創作的藝術作品

9. **painting = art/activity of painting — 繪畫；畫畫**

This is your second source use.

Practice 17 — Source

> “I did not know much about **painting**.”

「我當時不太懂**繪畫藝術**。」

Practice 18

> “She studied painting at university.”

「她在大學修讀**繪畫**。」

painting — uncountable noun = 使用顏料創作圖畫的藝術 / 活動

Important countability contrast:

> a painting

> = 一幅畫

> painting

> = 繪畫這門藝術

10. **painting = act/job of applying paint to walls/buildings — 油漆工程；髹漆**

A separate practical noun use.

Practice 19

> “The house needs **painting**.”

「這間屋需要**重新油漆 / 髹漆**。」

Practice 20

> “Painting the ceiling took all afternoon.”

「替天花板**油漆**花了整個下午。」

painting = 在牆壁、建築或物件表面塗油漆的工作 / 過程

This is distinct from artistic painting.

11. **painter = artist who paints pictures — 畫家**

Practice 21

> “Monet was a famous **painter**.”

「Monet 是一位著名**畫家**。」

Practice 22

> “The painter worked outdoors.”

「那位**畫家**在戶外創作。」

painter = 以繪畫創作藝術作品的人

12. **painter = person whose job is painting buildings/surfaces — 油漆工；髹漆工**

A major occupational polysemy.

Practice 23

> “We hired a **painter** to repaint the living room.”

「我們請了一名**油漆工**重新髹客廳。」

Practice 24

> “The painter finished the doors first.”

「那名**髹漆工**先完成了門的油漆工作。」

painter = 以油漆牆壁、建築物或物件為職業的人

Excellent contrast:

> painter = 畫家

> or

> painter = 油漆工

13. **painted = covered with paint — 塗上油漆的；上色的**

Practice 25

> “The walls are **painted** blue.”

「牆壁被**漆成藍色**。」

Practice 26

> “She bought a hand-painted box.”

「她買了一個**手繪的盒子**。」

****painted = 已被塗上顏料 / 油漆，或由人手繪製的****

14. ****paintwork = painted surface / quality of painting on a vehicle/building — 漆面；油漆表面****

A useful practical extension.

Practice 27

> “The car’s ****paintwork**** was badly scratched.”

「汽車的****漆面****被嚴重刮花。」

Practice 28

> “The old paintwork needs repair.”

「舊的****油漆表面****需要修補。」

****paintwork = 車輛、建築或物件表面的油漆層 / 漆面狀況****

Especially common in BrE.

15. ****oil paint (藝術) — 油畫顏料****

Practice 29

> “The artist works mainly in ****oil paint****.”

「那位畫家主要使用****油畫顏料****創作。」

Practice 30

> “Oil paint dries slowly.”

「****油畫顏料****乾得比較慢。」

****oil paint = 以油作為黏結 / 媒介成分的繪畫顏料****

16. **spray paint** (塗裝) — 噴漆

Practice 31

> “The metal frame was covered with **spray paint**.”

「金屬框架噴上了**噴漆**。」

Practice 32

> “They used spray paint on the sign.”

「他們用**噴漆**替招牌上色。」

spray paint = 以噴霧方式噴出的油漆 / 顏料

Important distinction: **paint** vs **draw**

This is one of the biggest learner contrasts.

paint

usually uses paint/colour as the medium.

> “She painted a flower.”

draw

usually uses lines with pencil, pen, charcoal, etc.

> “She drew a flower.”

So:

> paint = 用顏料畫

> draw = 用線條畫

But in digital software, the distinction can blur somewhat.

Important distinction: **paint** vs **painting**

paint

material:

> “I need more paint.”

= 我需要更多顏料 / 油漆。

painting

artwork:

> “I bought a painting.”

= 我買了一幅畫。

painting

activity:

> “I enjoy painting.”

= 我喜歡繪畫。

Very important three-way contrast.

Important distinction: **painting — countable vs uncountable**

Countable

> “a painting”

= 一幅畫作

Uncountable

> “painting is difficult”

= 繪畫這門藝術 / 活動很難

Your passage contains **both** uses.

Important distinction: **paint vs colour**

You just curated **colour**.

paint

= material used to create/change colour, or the act of applying it.

colour

= the visual property itself.

> blue paint

> = 藍色顏料

> blue colour

> = 藍色

So:

paint causes/provides colour, but they are not the same thing.

Important distinction: **painter = artist vs painter = tradesperson**

painter

can mean:

1. 畫家

2. 油漆工

Context decides.

> “a famous painter”

likely artist.

> “We hired a painter.”

likely tradesperson unless context says otherwise.

Important distinction: **paint a wall vs paint a picture**

paint a wall

= apply paint to the wall.

paint a picture

= create an artistic image.

Same verb, different activity.

Important distinction: **paint a picture — literal vs figurative**

Literal

> “She painted a picture of the garden.”

= 她畫了一幅花園圖畫。

Figurative

> “The report paints a worrying picture.”

= 報告**描繪出一幅令人擔憂的景象**。

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **paint vs describe**

describe

neutral:

= 說明 / 描述

paint

figurative:

= vividly portray, often shaping an image in the listener’s mind.

> “The article describes the city.”

neutral.

> “The article paints the city as vibrant and chaotic.”

more vivid and interpretive.

Important distinction: ****painted vs colourful****

****painted****

= colour was applied using paint.

****colourful****

= contains many vivid colours.

A wall can be:

> painted white

but not especially:

> colourful.

Different concepts.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * ****paint — material**** = 油漆 / 顏料
- * ****paint — coat a surface**** = 油漆 / 髹上
- * ****paint — make artwork**** = 繪畫
- * ****paint — depict artistically**** = 描繪
- * ****paint — describe figuratively**** = 生動描繪 / 刻畫
- * ****paint — digital**** = 數碼繪製 / 著色
- * ****paint — literary colour effect**** = 染上 / 使呈現色彩
- * ****painting — artwork**** = 畫作
- * ****painting — art/activity**** = 繪畫
- * ****painting — practical coating work**** = 油漆工程
- * ****painter — artist**** = 畫家
- * ****painter — tradesperson**** = 油漆工
- * ****painted**** = 上了油漆 / 手繪的

* **paintwork** = 漆面
* **oil paint** = 油畫顏料
* **spray paint** = 噴漆

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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paint — material	用來改變表面顏色或形成保護層的有色液體 / 物質
paint — coat a surface	把油漆 / 顏料塗在物件表面，使其變色或受保護
paint — art verb	使用顏料創作圖畫
paint — depict	把某人、某物或場景透過繪畫呈現出來
paint — figurative	用文字 / 言語把某人或某事生動描繪成某種形象
paint — digital	使用數碼繪圖工具在圖像上加顏色 / 筆觸
painting — artwork	一幅以顏料創作的藝術作品
painting — art/activity	使用顏料創作圖畫的藝術、技巧或活動
painting — practical work	在牆壁、建築或物件表面塗油漆的工作 / 過程
painter — artist	以繪畫創作藝術作品的人
painter — tradesperson	以油漆牆壁、建築或物件為職業的人
painted	已被塗上油漆 / 顏料，或由人手繪製的
paintwork	車輛、建築或物件表面的油漆層 / 漆面狀況
oil paint	以油作為媒介的繪畫顏料
spray paint	以噴霧方式施用的油漆 / 顏料

For your original passage

You actually have **two source uses**:

> “A **painting** I would really love to have in my home...”

= **一幅畫作**

and:

> “I did not know much about **painting**...”

= **繪畫這門藝術 / 活動**

The highest-value contrasts are:

> **paint** → 顏料 / 油漆

> **paint a wall** → 油漆牆壁

> **paint a picture** → 畫一幅畫

> **painting** → 畫作 **或** 繪畫活動

> **painter** → 畫家 **或** 油漆工

> **paint a picture of something** → 可字面「畫出」，也可比喻「生動描繪」